EASYCUT

CREATOR PLAYBOOK / 02



ENGLISH / US EDITION

# YouTube Shorts, Reels & TikTok: A Practical Playbook

A practical playbook for adapting one original video into three platform-specific versions for YouTube Shorts, Instagram Reels, and TikTok.

AI-generated illustrative creator

36 PAGES / 2026 EDITION

# Before You Start: How to Use This Book

How to Manage Three Platforms at Once

You're not just uploading the same file three times-you're translating the same idea into three different platform languages.

This book is a hands-on operational guide based on the official documentation for YouTube Shorts, Instagram Reels, and TikTok. Platform policies and interfaces may change, so always check the latest help resources before publishing.

What You'll Learn
- How to design a clean original video
- Platform-specific hooks and packaging
- Distribution calendars
- Comparing common metrics
- A 30-day action plan-all in one workflow

Key Points to Remember
- Upload eligibility, recommendation exposure, view counting, monetization requirements, and music rights are all separate issues.

Reference date: 2026.11.01 · For creators operating in South Korea (adapt guidance to your own region as needed)

# Contents

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# Core Principles: Not Copying, but Translating

Keep the Core Content Unified, but Design Discovery and Engagement Differently

1. Common Original
- Vertical frame (9:16), clear audio, safe subtitle area, clean file without logos

2. Platform Translation
- Adapt the first 2 seconds, title/caption, cover, music, and CTA to each platform’s style

3. Common Learning
- Compare reach, watch time, sharing, and conversions using the same questions, and apply insights to your next original

# Simultaneous Strategy Map: One Idea, Three Chances

You can target different viewing contexts on each platform without tripling your production costs.

Discovery
- Design the opening scene and packaging to suit each platform’s strengths

Engagement
- Track comments, shares, searches, and profile visits separately

Learning
- Feed winning hooks and topics back into your next original

# From One Master to Three Outputs: System Map

One original video yields three tailored outputs:

MASTER
- Clean 9:16 original

SHORTS
- Searchable topic
- Clear title
- Subscribe/next video CTA

REELS
- Shareable context
- Feed cover
- Save/profile CTA

TIKTOK
- Instant-reaction hook
- Native pacing
- Comment/follow-up CTA

You’re not changing the message itself, but the way it’s discovered and consumed on each platform.

# How to Use This Book

1. When grouping channels for the first time
Decide the role of each platform first on pages 8-13.

2. When starting filming and editing
Use the clean source and 3-version design from pages 15-19.

3. When creating an upload schedule
Copy the distribution flow and calendar from pages 21-24.

4. When results are inconsistent
Check the common metrics and diagnostic chart on pages 26-28.

5. When repeating with Easy Cut
Follow the workflow and 30-day plan on pages 30-35.

Instead of aiming for three perfect versions from the start, repeat the same format for four weeks and look for differences.

# Each Platform Has a Different Role

Set the role for each platform.

Goal of this section:
Decide the role each platform will play.

Remember: Even with the same content, each platform has different signals for success.

# Same Format, Different Contexts

The structure is similar, but the viewing context differs.

Common foundation:
Vertical video, immediate clarity in the opening moments, clear captions, fast pacing, and a visible subject on mobile are essential for all three platforms.

YouTube Shorts:
A content asset that can be discovered through search and recommendations for a long time.
Planning question: What does it teach?

Instagram Reels:
A brand asset shared within relationships and personal tastes.
Planning question: Who would someone want to send this to?

TikTok:
A fast-moving lab for immediate reactions and conversations.
Planning question: Why should someone stop and watch?

# Role Matrix: Assigning Platform Roles

Decide the role of each platform first.

Platform | Main Role | Strong Packaging | Key Signals
---|---|---|---
Shorts | Searchable content asset | Clear topic/title, series connection | View retention, subscribers, follow-up video movement
Reels | Shareable brand touchpoint | Cover/caption, save value | Shares, saves, profile actions
TikTok | Rapid experiment for reactions | Native hooks, comment conversations | Completion, comments, demand for sequels

Don't group all channels under the same goal-assign a distinct role to each channel.

# YouTube Shorts: Building Searchable Content Assets

Create a structure where clear topics and links to the next video remain relevant for a long time.

1. Include the topic in the title
Use a title that shows the problem, target, and result to clarify entry points for search and recommendations.

2. Make a promise in the opening scene
Show what information or change viewers will get in the first sentence and visual.

3. Connect as a series
Instead of just asking for subscriptions, first give a reason to watch the next video and link to related content.

YouTube will change Shorts view counting from March 31, 2025, to start and replay-based metrics, while the old method will remain as 'Engaged views.' Check the metric definitions when comparing results.

# Instagram Reels: Creating Shareable Brand Touchpoints

Make your Reels a brand connection point that people want to send and save, using covers, relatable context, and profile links.

1. Design the feed cover
Use short phrases and consistent layouts so the topic and outcome are clear even in your profile grid.

2. Add context in the caption
Include examples, checklists, or personal experiences that couldn't fit in the video to give people a reason to save it.

3. Check insights
With a professional account, track reach, engagement, and follower changes for each post.

Instagram allows Reels up to 20 minutes, but states that Reels over 3 minutes are not recommended to new users. For simultaneous multi-platform content, keep your original videos shorter and clearer.

# Quick Testing for TikTok Reactions

Use TikTok as a fast lab to gauge reactions by starting with a native-feeling opening shot and engaging in comment conversations to quickly test your topic.

1. Build Suspense First, Not Just Results
Show a reason to watch until the end-such as a test, twist, or challenge-right from your opening line and action.

2. Edit Like You're Speaking
Instead of aiming for a perfect ad, use cuts and captions that feel natural and match the viewer's rhythm.

3. Turn Comments Into Sequels
Sort questions and counterpoints from your comments, then create reply videos to continue the conversation.

Note: The Creator Rewards Program requires original, high-quality content over 1 minute, among other criteria. Strategies for quick view experiments may differ from those for the rewards program.

# Designing Three Versions from One Master

Create a clean master file and entry points tailored to each platform.

Goal of This Section:
Build a clean master and platform-specific entry points.

Remember: Even with the same content, each platform has different signals for success.

# Master File Specs for Multi-Platform Use

A clean master file that works across three platforms:

EasyCut Recommended Master Specs: 9:16 aspect ratio, 1080x1920 resolution, 30fps or higher, no logos in the file.

1. Visuals
Keep important faces, products, and captions within the central safe area of the frame.

2. Audio
Ensure narration is understandable and captions are easy to read, even without background music.

3. Music
If you don't have a universal license, keep a silent or rights-cleared master file.

4. Branding
Maintain a clean file without logos, UI elements, or watermarks from other platforms.

Note: Instagram's official guidance suggests upload ratios from 1.91:1 to 9:16, with a minimum of 720px and 30fps. 1080x1920 is EasyCut's recommended value for vertical video production.

# Adapting Hooks for Each Platform

Same conclusion, different first 2 seconds.

Original Topic: 'How to make a Shorts video in 10 minutes during your lunch break.'

SHORTS
"The exact steps to make one Shorts video in 10 minutes during lunch."
Intent: Promise what viewers will gain right away.

REELS
"I finished editing during lunch so I wouldn't have to do it after work."
Intent: Relatable scenario and result.

TIKTOK
"If I can't finish in 10 minutes, I'll ditch this method."
Intent: Instantly present tension and a test.

A hook isn't about exaggeration-it's about offering different entry points to the same value.

# Packaging: Titles, Captions, Covers, and CTAs

Store your title, caption, cover, and call-to-action separately for each platform.

SHORTS
- Title includes topic and result
- First line matches the video
- Connect to next video or subscribe
- Consistent series numbering

REELS
- Cover readable in feed
- Relatable, contextual caption
- Reasons to save or share
- Link to profile actions

TIKTOK
- First frame is the cover
- Short, conversational explanation
- Invite questions in comments
- Promise a follow-up video

If you duplicate the packaging document before the video file, you can manage all three versions more efficiently.

# Audio Rights Across Platforms

Audio tracks don't automatically transfer rights between platforms.

Just because a track is available in one app doesn't mean it's cleared for use in another app, in ads, or for external editing.

1. Simplest Approach
Keep a clean master with narration and sound effects only (or silent), then add platform-provided or approved music separately on each platform.

2. Universal License Approach
Check and keep proof that your music license covers multiple platforms, commercial use, and advertising.

3. Caution for Long Shorts
YouTube warns that Shorts over 1 minute with active Content ID claims may be blocked worldwide.

4. TikTok for Business
For commercial content, check the Commercial Music Library or other collections cleared for business use.

# Clean Export: Keep Editable Originals

Keep an editable master file for future revisions.

EXPORT STACK
MASTER_00
- Silent, no logo, safe subtitle area
YT_01
- Title, audio, end CTA
IG_01
- Cover, caption, save CTA
TT_01
- First frame, comment CTA, native audio

Save without other platform logos, UI, or watermarks.

Store script, subtitle files, and original covers together.

Include music license info and applicable platforms in the filename.

Separate editable project files from final exports.

If you have a clean original, you won't need to remake the entire video if platform policies change.

# Distribution: Repeatable Upload Checklist

Turn your upload process into a repeatable checklist.

Goal of this section:
Transform your upload routine into a checklist you can use every time.

Remember: Even with the same content, each platform has its own success signals.

# Publish Flow: Simultaneous Distribution in 60 Minutes

A 60-minute workflow for simultaneous distribution:

00-15 min: Clean Master
- Finalize video, subtitles, and thumbnail originals.

15-30 min: Triple Packaging
- Split hooks, titles, captions, covers, and CTAs for each platform.

30-45 min: Audio & Rights
- Check which music and usage rights apply to each platform.

45-60 min: Upload & Record
- Schedule or post, then log links and version names in your tracking sheet.

When you fix the order, managing three platforms becomes a checklist, not an editing chore.

# Publish Calendar: Test Timing and Context

Test on the same day, but at different times and contexts.

Prioritize your audience's activity times and the results of your last 10 posts over generic 'best times.'

Timing Example:
Shorts | Reels | TikTok
D-1: Title/Series | Cover/Caption | First frame/Question
D-DAY: Schedule/Post | Audience activity time | Experiment time slot
+2H: Check initial retention | Shares/Saves | Comments/Completion
+24H: Title/follow-up links | Stories/Replies | Comment video/sequel
+7D: Ongoing reach | Profile actions | Topic retest

Simultaneous strategy means creating comparable tests within the same campaign, not uploading at the exact same moment.

Record the audience timezone, not just your own clock. For a US audience, label experiments ET or PT and account for daylight saving time. Compare similar publication ages; there is no universal best posting hour.

# One Campaign, Three Platforms: Track Every Version

One production, three discovery opportunities.

Even if the master is the same, the opening scene, caption, cover, audio, and CTA should fit each platform's viewing context.

Keep all three version filenames and post links in a single sheet.

Version naming: topic_date_YT/IG/TT
Track: hook sentence, cover, audio, post time
Results: 2-hour, 24-hour, and 7-day metrics

# Community Loop: Turn Comments into Content

Unite all three comment sections into a single planning space.

1. Collect
Gather questions, objections, empathy, and examples from each platform.

2. Sort
Look for recurring questions rather than repeated phrases.

3. Translate
Adapt for each platform: Shorts (explanatory), Reels (relatable), TikTok (reply-based sequels).

4. Reuse
Use high-performing questions as the first two seconds of your next master video.

The number of questions you can turn into your next video matters more than the total comment count.

# Finding Reliable Signals Beyond Views

Subtitle: Seek repeatable signals rather than just chasing view counts.

Key Point: Even with the same content, each platform has its own indicators of success.

# Common KPIs for Multi-Platform Comparison

Compare using four key questions instead of raw view counts.

Each platform defines a view and exposure differently, so do not compare raw view numbers directly.

ATTENTION
Did viewers stop to watch?
- Early drop-off rate, retention graph, average watch time

DEPTH
Did they watch to the end?
- Completion rate, repeat views, watch time divided by video length

SPREAD
Did viewers share it?
- Shares, saves, reposts, and other available actions

CONVERSION
Did viewers take the next step?
- Follows, subscriptions, profile visits, next video clicks

Only use the metrics provided by each platform’s analytics dashboard, and always compare using the same time window (for example, 24 hours or 7 days after posting).

# Diagnosis: What to Change When Numbers Are Weak

When performance is weak, change only one thing at a time.

Early Drop-off
Possible cause: The opening scene is slow or the promise is unclear.
Next experiment: Change only the first 2 seconds and the captions.

Low Completion Rate
Possible cause: The pacing is slow or the conclusion is predictable.
Next experiment: Compress the middle explanation or move the conclusion.

Low Shares/Saves
Possible cause: The content has value but lacks a reason to keep or share.
Next experiment: Add a checklist, memorable line, or relatable example.

Low Follows/Subscribes
Possible cause: Viewers don’t see a reason to return.
Next experiment: Add a series name, tease future episodes, or clarify your profile promise.

Change only one variable at a time so you can clearly see which change led to improved results.

# Cross-Learning: Transfer Success Across Platforms

Move what works on one platform to experiments on others.

If Shorts perform best
- Likely due to strong topic demand and clear explanations.
Next experiment: For Reels, add relatable examples and a strong cover; for TikTok, repackage with a validated hook.

If Reels perform best
- Likely due to strong brand context for sharing and saving.
Next experiment: For Shorts, use a title with searchable keywords; for TikTok, test a first sentence based on personal experience.

If TikTok performs best
- Likely due to a strong opening scene and conversational tone.
Next experiment: For Shorts, structure the information; for Reels, reinforce context with a cover and captions.

Before giving up on a weak platform, translate the success signals from your strongest platform into the style and conventions of the weaker one.

# Easy Cut: Unified Multi-Platform Workflow

Subtitle: Integrate discovery, production, distribution, and learning into a single workflow.

Key Point: Even with the same content, each platform has its own indicators of success.

# Easy Cut Workflow: One Discovery, Three Distributions

01 Trend Discovery
- Identify topics that are just starting to gain traction and find original content candidates.

02 AI Highlights
- Analyze key scenes and segments suitable for Shorts.

03 Clean Master
- Edit for 9:16 aspect ratio, add captions and narration, and check rights.

04 Triple Adaptation
- Create platform-specific hooks, packaging, and calls to action (CTAs).

05 Performance Feedback
- Use common KPIs and comments to inform your next topic.

Spot trends early and claim your position with Shorts.

# One-Page Planning Sheet Before Upload

Fill out this page before uploading your video.

Common Topic
What is the one problem this video will solve?

Key Takeaway
What is the one sentence viewers should remember after watching?

Shorts Hook
Promise the search intent and result right away.

Reels Hook
Present a relatable situation and a reason to share.

TikTok Hook
Immediately show tension, proof, or reaction.

Platform-Specific CTA
Choose one for each: subscribe, save, or comment.

Music & Rights
List the source and usage rights for each platform.

Review Points
Check at 2 hours, 24 hours, and 7 days after posting.

Do not try to recall the differences between your three versions from memory after uploading. Instead, document them clearly before you publish.

# Track Results, Don’t Guess

Decide your next video based on records, not hunches.

When you track platform results using the same time frames and questions, you’ll start to see repeatable patterns rather than just differences in view counts.

2 Hours
Hook and initial reactions

24 Hours
Completion rate, shares, and comments

7 Days
Ongoing traffic and conversions

Copy winning topics, hooks, and structures directly into your plan for the following week.

# 30-Day Plan: Weeks 1-2

Weeks 1-2: Lock in your system

WEEK 1
- Establish your baseline
- Choose 3 topics
- Create 3 clean master videos
- Write 9 platform-specific hooks
- Create a sheet to track links and versions

WEEK 2
- First comparison
- Add 3 more master videos
- Publish a total of 9 versions
- Record metrics at 2 and 24 hours
- Select the strongest hook for each platform

In two weeks, you'll have 6 master videos and 18 uploads. Focus on well-documented experiments over just well-made videos.

# 30-Day Plan: Weeks 3-4

Weeks 3-4: Scale up winning patterns

WEEK 3
- Change only one variable at a time
- Reuse 2 winning topics
- Change only the hook or cover
- Turn comment questions into follow-up videos
- Strengthen packaging for weaker platforms

WEEK 4
- Bundle into a series
- Add 3 more master videos
- Complete 36 total uploads
- Compare 7-day conversion metrics
- Decide on 2 series for next month

30-day goal: 12 master videos, 36 platform versions, and 3 repeatable patterns for topics, hooks, and CTAs.

# Final 12-Point Pre-Distribution Checklist

Check all 12 items before simultaneous distribution:

1. You have a 9:16 clean master and an editable project file.
2. No other platform's logo, UI, or watermark is present.
3. The first 2-second hook is tailored for Shorts, Reels, and TikTok.
4. Title, caption, cover, and CTA fit each platform's role.
5. Subtitles and main subjects are not blocked by platform UI at the edges.
6. You've confirmed music source, commercial use rights, and proof for each platform.
7. You have a sheet to record upload filenames and post links.
8. Review times are set for 2 hours, 24 hours, and 7 days.
9. Compare interest, depth, spread, and conversions-not just raw views.
10. Only change one variable at a time if results are weak.
11. Collect questions from comments for future videos.
12. Apply winning patterns to next week's master plan.

Don't just copy one video three times-make one idea discoverable three different ways.

# Official sources

Open a title to read the official guidance. Recheck current terms before applying or publishing.

YouTube Shorts Getting Started

support.google.com
YouTube 3-Minute Shorts Guide

support.google.com
Instagram Reels Length

facebook.com
Instagram Reels Specifications

facebook.com
Instagram Reels Insights

facebook.com
Instagram Recommendation Eligibility

facebook.com

Instagram Audio

facebook.com
TikTok Creator Rewards

support.tiktok.com
TikTok Commercial Music Use

support.tiktok.com
FTC Disclosures

ftc.gov
US Copyright Fair Use

copyright.gov
Amazon Associates US

affiliate-program.amazon.com